

Investigate the physical conditions of a habitat and analyse how the growth and survival of living things is affected by changing physical conditions

Learning intention

- investigate the physical conditions of a habitat and analyse how the growth and survival of living things is affected by changing physical conditions.

Teach and model

- identifying the physical conditions in an aquatic or terrestrial habitat and how they change over time.
- investigating the effect of physical conditions on the growth of bread mould colonies in sealed plastic bags.
- investigating how changes to physical conditions such as salinity, soil type, sunlight or temperature affect plant growth.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.